

Outlook

From	riaan.swanepoel@cards.operations.keystonebank.co.za
To	analytics.retail@keystonebank.co.za, fraud.ops@keystonebank.co.za
Cc	cyber.security@keystonebank.co.za, customer.experience@keystonebank.co.za
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Are we blocking the right cards for the right reasons? - 2023 control review

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Card blocking protects customers, but repeated legitimate attempts and later complaints may reveal controls that are too blunt. Several teams are reporting more failed or retried activity than they expected, but they do not agree on the cause.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if ordinary PIN errors create avoidable blocks?
2. What evidence would instead support that blocked cards follow genuinely unusual sequences?
3. How do we rule out that customers receive inconsistent recovery paths?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use November 2023 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards where thresholds, escalation or customer communication should change. A useful output would be a model-ready table, data dictionary and an honest baseline.

Use ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: Do not label a block as incorrect without the rule decision and investigation outcome.

Regards